during Navratri. Besides the garments, Kathipabharat is also used in creating a range of home adorning textiles like chaklas, torans or textile door frames, cushion covers and mats.

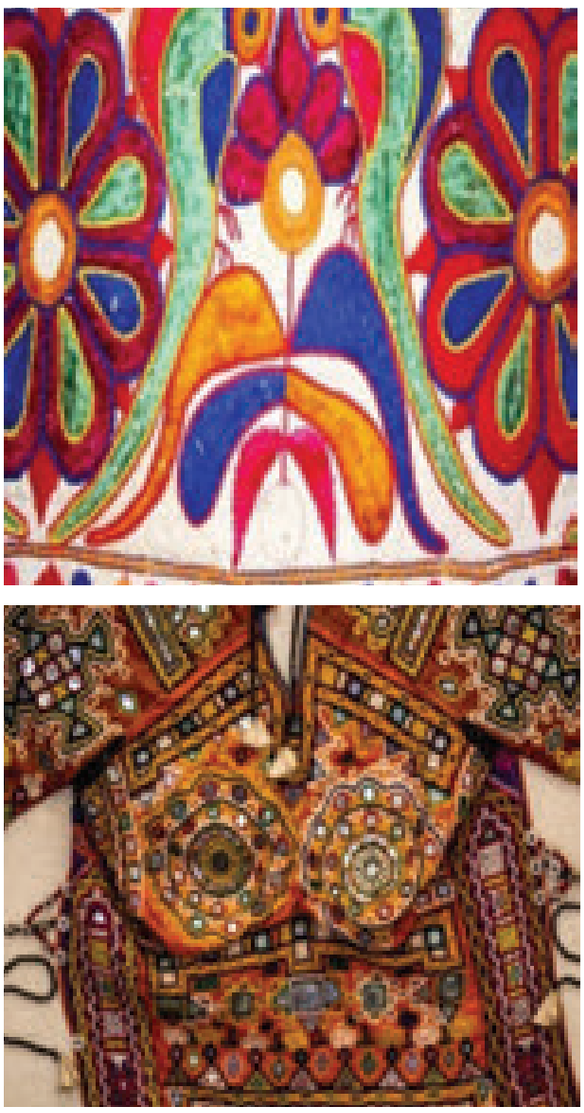


Figure 9.32 Kathi Embroidery

9.5.5 Kasuti Embroidery

Region

Kasuti embroidery is practiced in Karnataka. This is a promising craft produced by women. In early times, every bride would own a silk sari with Kasuti embroidery done on it.

Technique

The embroidery is done on a hand-woven cloth of darker colours. Cotton threads in different colours like red, orange, purple, green, yellow and blue are used. The embroidery threads used are drawn from the old silk sari borders.

Four Basic Stitches used are;

i. Gavanti - double running stitch that creates the same effect on both sides of fabric
ii. Murgi - zigzag running stitch that works in a stepwise manner
iii. Negi - simple running stitch that produces a weave-like effect, and
iv. Menthi - cross stitch that gives a heavier appearance.

Motifs

The motifs are inspired by religion, architecture, flora and fauna, and objects of daily use. Some examples are star-shaped designs, chariot, and palanquin for deity, tulsi pot holder, cradle, sacred bull, deer, elephant, peacock, horse, and lotus

Style of Embroidery

The embroidery uses a combination of horizontal, vertical and diagonal stitches. The motifs are not traced on the fabric and the embroidery is done by counting the yarns on the base material.

End Use

Traditionally the embroidery was made on Ikhat sari and other apparel items like women's blouse and children's bonnets. Presently Kasuti embroidery is also made on home products like cushion covers, bedcovers, curtains and accessories like handbags, mobile pouches, belts etc.

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